

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J
 ♥ A 6 5 4 3
 ♦ J 10 9 4
 ♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J



♠ 10 3

♥ Q 9 2

♦ K Q 8 7 5

♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 3 2
 ♥ J 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ K 10 6 5



♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 10 7 6

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.